

# Saturday, 19 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

## Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

22° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

22° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

19° 16°

GLASGOW

Light rain

16° 12°

01 — NEWS

## Today's top stories

- 'I'm telling the truth': Earl Spencer defends Diana book claims about Charles in BBC interview.**  
Princess Diana's brother tells the BBC's Laura Kuenssberg that "we'll forget her soon enough" were "exactly" the words used by the then-Prince of Wales.  
UK · NEWS
- Men lose appeal for harrasing BBC journalist over A Very British Cult documentary.**  
Kristofer Deichler, Jatinder Kamra and Sukhraj Singh were given community service and restraining orders for their harassment of Catrin Nye.  
UK · NEWS
- MI5 accepts it gave evidence based on lies in neo-Nazi spy case.**  
It is the first time MI5 has confirmed the BBC's revelation that it gave evidence based on lies in court while defending the violent informant.  
UK · NEWS
- Ex-Brookside star who fled after fraud trial arrested in Spain.**  
Philip Foster was already serving a jail sentence for conspiracy to defraud, as of last year.  
UK · NEWS
- Tenko and Coronation Street actress Stephanie Cole dies aged 84.**  
She was best known for playing Dr Beatrice Mason in the 1980s BBC wartime TV drama Tenko.  
UK · NEWS

## What's coming up

- 1 Tenko and Coronation Street actress Stephanie Cole dies aged 84.**  
She was best known for playing Dr Beatrice Mason in the 1980s BBC wartime TV drama Tenko.  
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 British rapper Sway dies aged 44.**  
Sway, whose hits included Still Speedin' and Level Up, was living in Ghana at the time of his death.  
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Resident Evil movie director says he was not prepared for fan backlash.**  
The video game adaptation is a hit with critics, but director Zach Cregger says the fan response surprised him.  
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 US fans with Ed Sheeran tickets left 'torn' over Macklemore controversy.**  
With Sheeran's next gig this weekend, some ticket holders said they were in two minds about going.  
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Zara Larsson criticises White House for using her song in deportation video.**  
The White House removed Larsson's Midnight Sun from one of its reels after the artist called the clip "dehumanising".  
SHOWBIZ · UK

## On the schedule

- 1 Oxford apologise for United 93 shirt advert.**  
Oxford United apologises for the image, which features the call sign of one of the planes used in the 9/11 attacks.  
SPORT · UK
- 2 Gabriel, 15, in Barcelona amid speculation over future.**  
Man Utd youngster JJ Gabriel travels to Barcelona as some of Europe's biggest clubs continue to vie for his signature.  
SPORT · UK
- 3 Uefa & Concacaf demand Fifa pays \$10m to all 211 members.**  
Uefa and Concacaf issue a joint statement calling on Fifa to pay \$10m from its cash reserves to each of the 211 member associations.  
SPORT · UK
- 4 London City's new training centre 'better than most Premier League clubs' - Kang.**  
Michele Kang believes London City Lionesses' planned new training ground will set a new standard in the women's game and surpass facilities used by most men's Premier League clubs.  
SPORT · UK
- 5 Carse assault investigation dropped by police.**  
England fast bowler Brydon Carse will face no further police action after an investigation into an alleged assault in Derby last month is dropped.  
SPORT · UK

## Quick hits

- 1 Cash is making a small comeback — ATM withdrawals are up 14% on this time last year.**  
Bank analysts credit budget-conscious households using cash to stay disciplined. The 'envelope method' is back trending on TikTok.
- 2 Jigsaw puzzles are still selling in huge numbers, years after their lockdown boom.**  
1,000-piece designs are the sweet spot. The most dreaded puzzle remains anything that's mostly sky.
- 3 Brits are apparently buying more houseplants than ever — and naming them.**  
A garden survey found nearly a third of plant owners have given their plants names, and a surprising number apologise to them when they forget to water.
- 4 The humble flask is having a comeback, with sales up sharply as people try to cut café spending.**  
Retailers say the big winner is the 'keeps drinks hot for 12 hours' bottle — though most of us still drink it within the first one.
- 5 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**  
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 6 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**  
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 7 More households are growing herbs on the windowsill to cut grocery bills.**  
Basil and mint are the favourites. Survival rates, gardeners admit, are 'mixed' — the basil rarely makes it past a fortnight.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

### OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** 65% of us still do THIS even though every map app exists.

**ANSWER:** ASK A STRANGER FOR DIRECTIONS AND THEN IMMEDIATELY IGNORE THEM.
- Q** Asked what's in the bottom of nearly every handbag, the top answer was THIS.

**ANSWER:** A SINGLE MYSTERIOUS RECEIPT FROM 2019.

### TALK TOPIC

- **Apparently 1 in 5 of us have a 'comfort show' we've watched more than 10 times.**  
Talk-back: what's yours? Friends? Gavin and Stacey? Bake Off? Reveal yourself.
- **If you could un-invent ONE thing from modern life, what would it be?**  
Talk-back: not phones. Pick something specific. Self-checkouts? Wireless earbuds that always die? The Selfridges Christmas advert?

### TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

- FACT** **Geography.** Russia and the United States are less than 4 km apart at their closest point — two small islands in the Bering Strait known as the Diomedes.
- FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** A village in Wales has been officially recognised as having the UK's narrowest high street, where shopkeepers can shake hands across the road from their doorways.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£25 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£3.8 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- A blue whale's tongue alone weighs as much as an elephant.
- Octopuses can taste with their suckers.
- Wales has more castles per square mile than any other country in the world.
- Bananas grow upside down.
- Your nose can detect over a trillion different scents.
- The unicorn is the national animal of Scotland.
- There are more trees on Earth than stars in the Milky Way.
- A snail can sleep for three years at a time.

## On this day

Day 262 of the year, 103 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alonso de Orozco Mena; Christian feast day: Emilie de Rodat; Christian feast day: Blessed Francisca Cualladó Baixauli; Christian feast day: Goeric of Metz. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1927 — Nick Massi, American singer and bass player (died 2000)
- 1964 — Patrick Marber, English actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1995 — Brent Faiyaz, American singer
- 1936 — Martin Fay, Irish fiddler (died 2012)
- 1975 — Marcus Dunstan, American director and screenwriter
- 1952 — Rhys Chatham, American trumpet player, guitarist, and composer
- 1995 — Rachel Sennott, American actress
- 1963 — Jarvis Cocker, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

### THE DAY TODAY

- 1960 — Indian Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru and Pakistani President Ayub Khan sign the Indus Waters Treaty for the control and management of the Indus, Chenab, Jhelum, Ravi, Sutlej and Beas rivers.
- 2023 — Azerbaijan launches a military offensive against the Republic of Artsakh in the Nagorno-Karabakh region; this leads to the flight of the Armenian population.
- 2008 — A Learjet 60 carrying musicians Travis Barker and Adam "DJ AM" Goldstein crashes during a rejected takeoff from Columbia Metropolitan Airport in West Columbia, South Carolina, killing four of the six people on board. Barker and Goldstein both survive.

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1985 — Tipper Gore and other political wives form the Parents Music Resource Center as Frank Zappa, John Denver, and other musicians testify at U.S. Congressional hearings on obscenity in rock music.
- 1976 — Turkish Airlines Flight 452 hits the Taurus Mountains, outskirt of Karatepe, Turkey, killing all 154 passengers and crew.

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2006 — The Thai army stages a coup. The Constitution is revoked and martial law is declared.

- 2021 — The Cumbre Vieja volcano, on the island of La Palma in the Canary Islands, erupts. The eruption lasts for almost three months, ending on December 13.
- 2010 — The leaking oil well in the Deepwater Horizon oil spill is sealed.

## A peek at tomorrow

Day 263 of the year, 102 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Eustace (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Evilasius; Christian feast day: Fausta of Cyzicus; Christian feast day: Glycerius of Milan. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1978 — Charlie Weber, American actor
- 1970 — N'Bushe Wright, American actress and dancer
- 1948 — John Panozzo, American drummer (died 1996)
- 1936 — Andrew Davies, Welsh author, screenwriter, and producer
- 1969 — Ben Shepherd, American musician and songwriter
- 1986 — Aldis Hodge, American actor
- 1962 — Jim Al-Khalili, Iraqi-English physicist, author, and academic
- 1976 — Jon Bernthal, American actor

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1989 — USAir Flight 5050 crashes into Bowery Bay during a rejected takeoff from LaGuardia Airport, killing two people.
- 2008 — A dump truck full of explosives detonates in front of the Marriott hotel in Islamabad, Pakistan, killing 54 people and injuring 266 others.
- 2003 — Civil unrest in the Maldives breaks out after a prisoner is killed by guards.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2008 — A dump truck full of explosives detonates in front of the Marriott hotel in Islamabad, Pakistan, killing 54 people and injuring 266 others.
- 2007 — Between 15,000 and 20,000 protesters march on Jena, Louisiana, United States, in support of six black youths who had been convicted of assaulting a white classmate.

# Coming to cinemas

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SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25                      Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16                      Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23                      Frankenstein (del Toro)

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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

## On the sporting calendar